

Illustrative Four-Square constitutional overlay only — not upstream Django governance.

PROJECT CONSTITUTION / CONTRACT / LETTERHEAD

FOUR-SQUARE RELEASE LINEAGE

main1 = repository first commit / immutable root reference

SPEC spec-v1.2	CODE code-v1.2	DOCS docs-v1.2	MEMORY memory-v1.2
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SPEC and MEMORY are fixed. The two middle lanes are project-defined and **SHOULD** remain stable across versions.

CONSTITUTIONAL LANGUAGE

MUST / MUST NOT binding law	SHALL / SHALL NOT constitutional alias	SHOULD / SHOULD NOT strong guidance	MAY permitted option	EXCEPTION / WAIVER explicit departure
MISSION Provide a coherent framework for building database-backed web applications with mature integrated facilities.		CORE PRINCIPLE CODE and DOCS SHOULD remain aligned; deviations SHOULD be explicit.		BOUNDARY Application business logic and deployment policy remain with consuming projects.

CONSTITUTIONAL HIERARCHY / FORMS

CONSTITUTION → ARTICLES / LAWS → CONTRACTS → POLICIES → GUARDRAILS → RECOMMENDED PRACTICES → CHECKLISTS

The form label does not determine force; the normative keyword does.

ARTICLES / LAWS / CONTRACTS / GUARDRAILS

ID	FORM	FORCE	CLAUSE
LAW-DJANGO-001	LAW	MUST	Declared public behavior MUST have scoped implementation evidence and aligned developer guidance.
GUARD-DJANGO-002	GUARDRAIL	MUST NOT	DOCS MUST NOT knowingly describe behavior unsupported by accepted CODE.
POLICY-DJANGO-003	POLICY	SHOULD	Compatibility changes SHOULD record affected versions, migration guidance and scoped evidence.
CONTRACT-DJANGO-004	CONTRACT	MUST	Release evidence MUST distinguish proven behavior from illustrative material and MUST state its scope.
LAW-MEMORY-005	LAW	MUST NOT	MEMORY MUST NOT create new framework law unless promoted into SPEC.

CONFORMANCE / EXCEPTION DECLARATION

CONFORMANT	CONFORMANT WITH EXCEPTION	NON-CONFORMANT	NOT YET PROVEN
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A **MUST** / **MUST NOT** deviation **MUST** be visible. An **EXCEPTION** / **WAIVER** **MUST** identify clause ID, scope, owner, rationale, evidence and review/expiry condition where applicable.

RELEASE LAW

Draft ≠ Tested ≠ Accepted ≠ Released. Claims **MUST** be scoped to evidence actually validated. An accepted release **MUST** record the exact four reviewed lane commits. The snapshot **MUST NOT** replace Git. TOUCH EVERYTHING REQUIRED; COMPLETE LITTLE; GROW WHAT IS PROVEN. One version, four squares, all green.

PAGE 2 — GOVERNANCE / DEVELOPMENT / EXCEPTIONS

Use when project complexity requires more than the one-page constitutional identity.

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DEVELOPMENT GOVERNANCE — RECOMMENDED CHECKLIST

- ☐ Every material iteration **MUST** declare STRATEGY and TOUCHPOINT SET.
- ☐ Every declared touchpoint **MUST** be exercised meaningfully for the claimed path; implementation at a touchpoint **MAY** be intentionally tiny.
- ☐ Strategy **MAY** be E2E, E2M, M2E, PARALLEL E2E, MEET-IN-THE-MIDDLE or INCREMENTAL E2E; START / MIDPOINT / END **MUST** be named where applicable.
- ☐ A component test **MUST NOT** be represented as E2E proof, and an E2E claim **MUST NOT** bypass any touchpoint declared in its Touchpoint Set.
- ☐ Important implementation material **SHOULD** be recorded as TECHNOLOGY / LIBRARY / REFERENCE / LINK with FORCE, RELATION, PURPOSE and SOURCE; REUSE / INHERIT / REFERENCE **SHOULD** be explicit where assumptions could leak.

EXCEPTION / WAIVER PROTOCOL

CLAUSE	SCOPE	OWNER	RATIONALE	EVIDENCE	REVIEW / EXPIRY
[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]

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